

CVE-2026-13181 - Remote Code Execution via Unsafe Type Resolution

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- Published: date not stated
- Original: <https://www.ionix.io/threat-center/cve-2026-13181/>
- Preserved from: <https://www.ionix.io/threat-center/cve-2026-13181/> (preserved-copy) on 2026-08-04
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Content

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Summary

CVE-2026-13181 is a high-severity vulnerability in Progress Telerik UI for ASP.NET AJAX affecting all versions from 2010.1.309 through 2026.2.519, fixed in v2026.2.708. The flaw arises from the RadAsyncUpload component resolving server-side .NET types from attacker-controlled upload metadata — specifically the `AsyncUploadTypeName` parameter — without adequate validation, enabling unauthenticated remote code execution. The vulnerability is classified under CWE-470 (Use of Externally-Controlled Input to Select Classes or Code) and carries a CVSS v3.1 base score of 8.1 (HIGH).

Technical details

- **Root cause:** The RadAsyncUpload handler (`Telerik.Web.UI.WebResource.axd`) processes type names supplied within forged upload metadata. The `AsyncUploadTypeName` field is resolved to a .NET type without sufficient validation, enabling an attacker to influence object instantiation on the server — an object injection pattern classified as CWE-470 / CAPEC-586.
- **Trigger conditions:** The application must have the RadAsyncUpload control in active use and the async upload handler must not have been explicitly disabled via the `Telerik.Web.DisableAsyncUploadHandler` configuration key.
- **Attack vector:** Network-delivered over HTTP/HTTPS; no authentication required, no user interaction required. The handler endpoint is accessible to unauthenticated

internet users on affected deployments.

- **Impact:** Full remote code execution on the server — confidentiality, integrity, and availability are all rated HIGH (C:H/I:H/A:H). Successful exploitation can result in complete server compromise.

Affected software

- Progress Telerik UI for ASP.NET AJAX versions **2010.1.309 through 2026.2.519** (inclusive) — all versions prior to the 2026 Q2 SP1 release

Severity

- **CVSS v3.1 Base Score:** 8.1 (HIGH)
- **Vector string:** CVSS:3.1/AV:N/AC:H/PR:N/UI:N/S:U/C:H/I:H/A:H

Note: The High Attack Complexity (AC:H) reflects the prerequisite that RadAsyncUpload must be actively configured in the application. It does not reduce severity for environments meeting that condition.

Mitigation and recommended actions

- **Immediate — upgrade:** Apply **Progress Telerik UI for ASP.NET AJAX v2026.2.708** (2026 Q2 SP1) or later. This release addresses the unsafe type resolution in AsyncUploadTypeName handling.
- **If immediate upgrade is not feasible — workarounds:**
 - Disable the async upload handler entirely by setting `Telerik.Web.DisableAsyncUploadHandler` to `true` in `web.config`. This blocks the vulnerable code path if RadAsyncUpload functionality is not required.
 - Configure strong, manually generated machine keys in IIS using HMACSHA256 validation to reduce the effectiveness of forged metadata. Do not rely on auto-generated keys.
 - Review and restrict network access to the `Telerik.Web.UI.WebResource.axd` handler endpoint where possible.

IONIX Status

The IONIX research team is tracking ongoing exploitation attempts and recommends immediate patching. Potentially affected assets are outlined in this post.

References

- [CVE-2026-13181 at NIST NVD](#)
- [Progress Telerik Vendor Advisory \(CVE-2026-13181\)](#)

